07-21 第二篇

Overcoming Procrastination

Procrastination—putting off tasks until the last moment—is a habit that many people struggle with. Students delay homework until the night before it is due; adults postpone projects until deadlines approach. While a little delay might seem harmless, chronic procrastination can lead to stress, poor performance, and missed opportunities. [1] Understanding why we procrastinate can help us develop better strategies. We often procrastinate when tasks feel overwhelming, boring, or fear-inducing. Breaking tasks into smaller steps, making them more enjoyable, or addressing our fears can make a real difference.

[2] One effective approach is to start with just a small part of the task. Instead of thinking "I have to write an entire essay," try "I will write one paragraph." This makes the work feel less intimidating and helps build momentum. Once you begin, you often find it easier to continue. The "two-minute rule" suggests that if a task takes less than two minutes, do it immediately—this prevents small tasks from piling up and adding to your mental load.

[3] Creating the right environment can also reduce procrastination. A cluttered desk, constant phone notifications, or a noisy room can make it hard to focus. Try to create a dedicated workspace, turn off unnecessary distractions, and set specific times for work. Some people find that working in short blocks—such as 25 minutes of focus followed by a 5-minute break—helps them stay productive. Your environment and routine send signals to your brain about when it is time to work.

[4] Dealing with the emotional side of procrastination is equally important. Many people procrastinate because they fear failure, perfectionism, or negative feedback. Instead of avoiding these feelings, acknowledge them and remind yourself that imperfect progress is better than no progress. Celebrate small wins to build confidence. If you notice that procrastination is linked to anxiety or low mood, seeking support from friends, family, or a counselor can be helpful.

[5] Overcoming procrastination is a process that takes practice and patience, but it is achievable. By understanding our triggers, using practical strategies, and being kind to ourselves along the way, we can develop healthier work habits. The goal is not to never procrastinate again—everyone delays sometimes—but to reduce its hold on our lives so that we can focus on what truly matters. Small steps today can lead to big changes over time.

选项

A. Recognizing the causes of procrastination is the first step toward changing our habits. B. Starting small and breaking tasks into manageable parts can make them less overwhelming. C. A well-organized workspace and clear routines can help create conditions for focus and productivity. D. Addressing the emotions behind procrastination is essential for lasting change. E. With the right strategies and a patient attitude, we can take control of procrastination over time. F. For example, some students work best late at night while others are more productive in the morning.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前描述拖延的普遍性与危害，空后分析拖延的常见原因（任务过重、无聊、恐惧等）及应对方向。A 句 "Recognizing the causes of procrastination is the first step toward changing our habits" 承接 "understanding why"，并自然过渡到后文策略讨论，承上启下。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：段落介绍从小处入手的策略。空后具体说明 "write one paragraph"、"two-minute rule" 等。B 句 "Starting small and breaking tasks into manageable parts can make them less overwhelming" 准确概括本段主旨。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：段落讲环境与作息对减少拖延的作用。空后提到整洁桌面、关闭通知、番茄工作法等。C 句 "A well-organized workspace and clear routines can help create conditions for focus and productivity" 精准对应本段内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：段落强调处理拖延背后的情绪。空后提到对失败、完美主义的恐惧，以及接纳情绪、寻求支持。D 句 "Addressing the emotions behind procrastination is essential for lasting change" 与前文 "emotional side" 及 "anxiety or low mood" 呼应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段总结克服拖延是渐进的、可达成的过程。E 句 "With the right strategies and a patient attitude, we can take control of procrastination over time" 与前文 "practice and patience"、"practical strategies"、"Small steps today" 自然衔接。

- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example...**：虽涉及工作效率（早晚偏好），但属于个人差异举例，与 procrastination 主题关联较弱。作为独立选项，其论述层次错位，且未与任一空位形成段落级衔接，易因 "productive" 与第 3 段 "productive" 混淆而误选。